

The 57th Socialist Manifesto

Theme: *The US We Want: Social, Democratic, Sustainable*

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Introduction: A Vision for the People

We stand at a pivotal moment in American history. Following the crises of the post-2016 era—the pandemic, economic inequality, climate emergency, and rising authoritarianism—we reaffirm our commitment to a United States that guarantees rights for all.

Our vision is not merely to manage capitalism, but to transform it into a system where social, economic, and environmental progress go hand in hand. We are building a **Socialist America**: one that is feminist, inclusive, and founded on universal human rights. We believe the government must ensure life is bearable for all citizens, protecting their liberties while dismantling corporate dominance over our democracy.

Core Principles

- **Socialism for the People:** Prioritizing human welfare over corporate profit.
 - **Universal Rights:** Free education, universal healthcare, a living wage, and the right to unionize.
 - **Civic Liberties:** Protecting the separation of Church and State, bodily autonomy (pro-choice), and the abolition of the death penalty.
 - **Democratic Socialism:** Extending democracy from the political ballot box into the economic workplace.
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Part I: Who We Are – The SDA Stance

The **Social Democrats of America (SDA)** identify as the inheritor of the original Democratic Socialists of America (DSA), specifically its democratic socialist lineage. We are resolutely **social-democratic**, embracing the principle that *"Politics is the art of the possible."*

Our Ideological Line

We reject the notion that reform cannot solve the immediate suffering caused by capitalism. While we recognize the long-term contradictions of capitalism, we insist that **reformism works**.

- **The Success of Reform:** As highlighted in Donald Sassoon's *One Hundred Years of*

Socialism, Western Europe proved that "mere reformism" could establish universal healthcare, expand the welfare state, and decouple poverty from the working class.

- **The Failure of the Far Left:** We fundamentally disagree with the Bolshevik-legacy traditions (Leninism, Trotskyism, Stalinism, Maoism). For over a century, these movements failed to create genuine liberating societies. Instead, they resulted in "bureaucratic collectivism" or "state capitalism," where a "vanguard party" ruled *over* the proletariat rather than *for* them.
- **Rejection of Democratic Centralism:** SDA upholds a principled ban on democratic-centralist organizations. We believe in individual autonomy, the right to dissent, and open debate. We do not accept robotic allegiance to self-appointed vanguards.

Our Coalition Strategy

We view liberalism as "incomplete" but essential. Unlike far-left sectarianism, we actively build coalitions with honest grassroots liberals and progressives. Our goal is to form a "big tent" that excludes only those committed to authoritarianism, while welcoming anyone willing to work toward a more just society.

Our Goal: To reclaim the achievements of the New Deal and the post-WWII Labor governments, restoring the welfare state that neoliberalism has dismantled since the Reagan-Thatcher years.

Part II: The 20 Commitments for 2028

As we approach the 2028 Presidential election, the SDA presents 20 concrete commitments for our candidate in the Democratic Party. These are divided into three pillars: **Quality of Life**, **Open & Democratic Societies**, and **A Fairer World**.

Pillar 1: Solutions for a Better Quality of Life

1. Securing Quality Jobs for All

Employment rates fluctuate, but stability must not. We demand a shift from "jobs at any cost" to "quality jobs."

- **Economic Power:** Raise salaries to combat inflation, close gender pay gaps by 2030, and enforce pay transparency.
- **Worker Protection:** Strengthen collective bargaining, regulate Artificial Intelligence to protect workers, limit excessive CEO-to-worker pay ratios, and guarantee the "right to disconnect."
- **Future of Work:** Eliminate in-work poverty, end labor exploitation, and create local job guarantees. We will empower trade unions and support the self-employed.

- **Training:** Guarantee paid time for workers to learn new skills needed for the green and digital transitions.

2. A New Green Social Deal

Climate justice is social justice. The most vulnerable suffer most from climate change; therefore, the transition to green energy must be fair.

- **Just Transition:** Reach climate neutrality by 2040 (with 2050 as the hard ceiling) while ensuring no worker or community is left behind.
- **Energy Security:** Invest in renewable energy and efficiency to ensure affordable, reliable power for all households and small businesses.
- **Combating Energy Poverty:** Reform energy markets to stabilize prices and guarantee supply for the vulnerable.

3. A Strong, Open Economy

We advocate for a "Social Market Economy" using public investment to build resilience.

- **Industrial Strategy:** Implement a "Made in the US" strategy to reindustrialize the nation, focusing on SMEs, startups, cooperatives, and female/young entrepreneurs.
- **Fair Trade:** Support a fair NAFTA and global competition policies that level the playing field against unfair foreign subsidies.
- **Sovereignty:** Secure the domestic supply of energy, raw materials, medicines, and food.
- **Investment Capacity:** Create a permanent federal investment capacity and budget to fund green and social projects, rejecting austerity at all costs.

4. Tax Justice

A fair tax system is the foundation of a fair society.

- **Pay Their Share:** Enact effective taxes on corporations, windfall profits, financial transactions, and the ultra-rich.
- **Global Cooperation:** Fight tax havens and fraud globally, aiming for a Global Minimum Corporate Tax Rate.
- **Equity:** Ensure tax systems eliminate all forms of gender discrimination.

5. Affordable Housing

Housing is a human right, not a speculative asset.

- **National Plan:** Launch an American Plan for Affordable Housing with significant federal investment.
- **Renovation:** Drive a massive renovation wave to improve energy efficiency in both public and private buildings, reducing utility bills for tenants.

6. Universal Health & Medicine

Universal access to healthcare is non-negotiable.

- **Public Healthcare:** Defend and expand public systems that create quality care jobs.
- **Pandemic Defense:** Establish a "United States Health Union" to coordinate cross-state pandemic responses.
- **Mental Health:** Implement a robust national mental health strategy.
- **Drug Pricing:** Regulate medicine pricing to prevent shortages and ensure timely access to rare disease treatments.

7. Public Services at the Core

Well-funded public services are the safety net against life's hardships.

- **Guaranteed Access:** Ensure quality healthcare, affordable energy/water, and inclusive education for everyone, regardless of location.
- **Transportation:** Build a nationwide clean, affordable railway network to fight "mobility poverty" in rural areas.

8. Environmental Sustainability & Agriculture

- **Ecological Defense:** Fight plastic pollution (especially PFAS "forever chemicals"), microplastics, and chemical runoff. Protect water resources and biodiversity.
- **Support Farmers:** Strengthen agricultural policy to support young, women, and small-scale farmers. Provide financial aid for transitioning to sustainable farming methods.
- **Food Security:** Ensure farmers can provide healthy, affordable food without being undercut by speculation or unfair foreign competition.

9. Security & Justice

Safety must be achieved through justice and cooperation, not just enforcement.

- **Crimes:** Improve police and judicial cooperation against terrorism, organized crime, drug trafficking, and cyber-crime.
- **Vulnerable Groups:** Specifically target phone/internet fraud that exploits the elderly and strengthen protections against gender-based violence.
- **Institutions:** Empower the Department of Labor and FINCEN with better investigative tools to support states.

10. Regional Solidarity

- **Cohesion:** Invest in a Cohesion Policy to reverse the "brain drain" from rural areas and remote regions.
- **Self-Determination:** Call for referendums on statehood/self-determination for

Pillar 2: Solutions for Open and Democratic Societies

11. Defend Democracy

Democracy is our best defense against autocracy.

- **Rule of Law:** Maintain a trustworthy justice system and media freedom.
- **Anti-Corruption:** Implement strict sanctions ensuring no funding reaches autocratic governments or entities that undermine democratic norms.
- **Opposition to the Far Right:** We maintain a "red line": **No coalition with the far right.** We condemn parties that enable them, viewing the far right as a poison to democracy that pits people against one another.

12. A Feminist America

We are the party of feminism.

- **Bodily Autonomy:** Guarantee free, full access to reproductive health and rights.
- **Equality:** Close gender pay, care, and pension gaps by 2030 through binding legislation.
- **Violence Prevention:** Make gender-based violence a federal crime, adopt the "yes means yes" consent standard, and fully implement international conventions on women's rights.

13. Zero Discrimination

- **Tolerance:** Zero tolerance for sexism, racism, antisemitism, Islamophobia, and homophobia.
- **Legislation:** Push for a comprehensive Anti-Discrimination Directive and strategies for disability rights.

14. Migration & Asylum

Migration is a strength when managed with humanity.

- **Legal Pathways:** Establish safe, legal pathways for asylum and migration, respecting human dignity.
- **Protection:** Protect migrant children and minors above all else.
- **Border Management:** Secure borders effectively but refuse to criminalize humanitarian aid. Oppose the "externalization" of borders (exporting border control to other nations).
- **Return:** Ensure return decisions are carried out safely and legally.

15. A Future for Young People

- **Political Power:** Lower the voting age to 16 and empower youth as candidates.

- **Education & Work:** Guarantee free quality education, paid internships, and full youth employment.
- **Housing:** Launch a specific plan to solve the student housing crisis and eradicate child poverty.

16. Intergenerational Solidarity

- **Senior Rights:** Protect pensions, healthcare, and housing for seniors, fighting ageism and ensuring gender equity in retirement benefits.

17. Digital Rights & AI Control

- **Human Control:** Ensure AI serves workers and citizens, never replacing human judgment in critical decisions ("human-in-the-loop").
 - **Online Safety:** Tackle disinformation, hate speech, and online harassment. Illegal actions offline must remain illegal online.
 - **Access:** Guarantee high-speed internet as a fundamental public utility.
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Pillar 3: Solutions for a Fairer World

18. America's Place in the World

The US must lead responsibly in a dangerous world.

- **Defense:** Implement a strong Common Security and Defense Policy that complements NATO but strengthens strategic autonomy.
- **Ukraine:** Maintain unwavering support for Ukraine until territorial integrity is restored and a just peace is achieved.
- **Diplomacy:** Speak with one voice on foreign policy. Strengthen the State Department to defend US values.
- **Expansion:** Welcome EU (and global democratic alliance) membership for Ukraine, Moldova, and Bosnia; support Georgia's aspirations. Pause Turkey's accession process unless democratic reforms occur.

19. Peace & Fundamental Values

- **Multilateralism:** Center our foreign policy on a reformed United Nations and the Sustainable Development Goals.
- **Middle East:** Support an equitable two-state solution for Israel and Palestine, ensuring security and rights for both peoples. Push for a sustainable ceasefire.
- **Feminist Foreign Policy:** Promote peace, human rights, and climate justice globally.

20. Renewed International Cooperation

- **Alliances:** Strengthen ties with Europe, the Commonwealth, and other democracies.
 - **Global South:** Build partnerships of equals with Africa and Latin America, focusing on green energy, climate resilience, and social progress.
 - **Trade:** Enforce binding human rights and labor standards in all trade agreements.
 - **China:** Rebalance relations with China—protecting US interests and values while cooperating on urgent global issues like climate change.
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Conclusion: The Path Forward

The SDA does not offer a utopian fantasy, but a practical roadmap grounded in the belief that **we can build a United States of sustainability and democracy.**

We face a far right that seeks division, and a status quo that offers insecurity. Our answer is unity, solidarity, and action. By mobilizing progressive, social, and environmental forces, we will deliver a future where:

- No one is left behind.
- Workers have dignity.
- The planet is protected.
- Democracy reigns supreme.

The US we want is within reach. Let us march together to claim it.